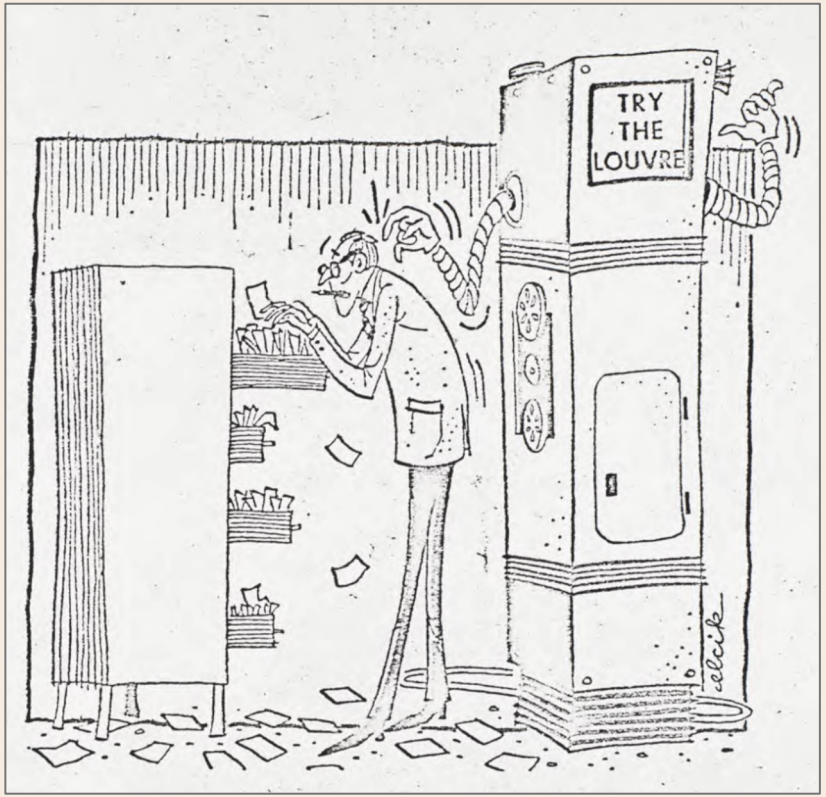


“The computer has entered the house of the Muse”: Everett Ellin, From Dealing to Digital Humanism

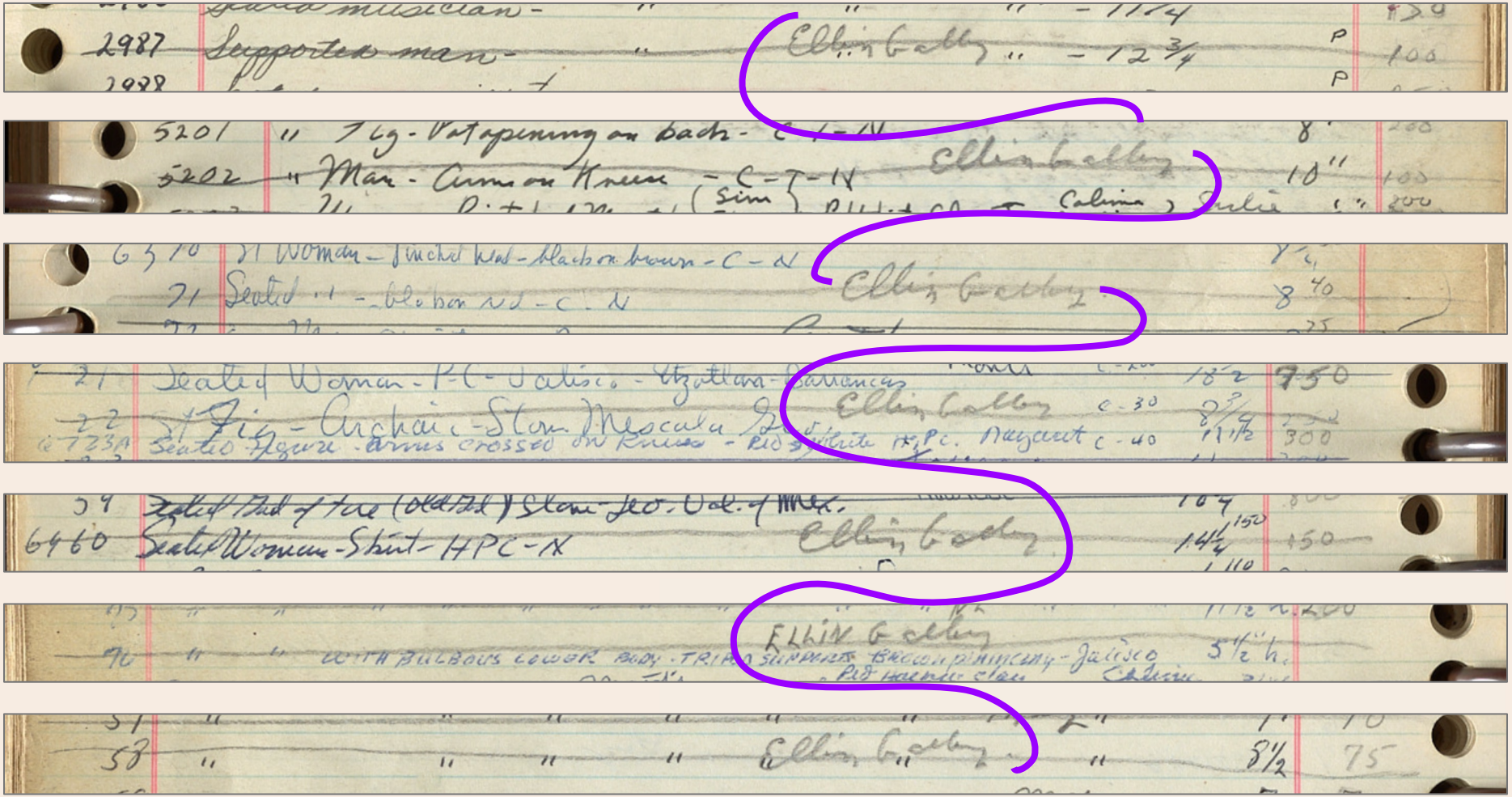
Kylie G. King, Research Specialist
Getty Research Institute, Los Angeles

Payton P. Quintanilla, Curator/Librarian
Hesburgh Libraries, University of Notre Dame

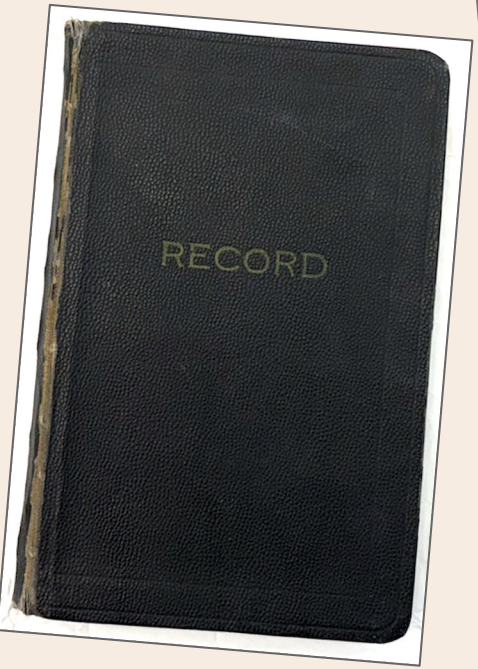
The Stendahl Art Galleries Archive as a Gateway to Pre-Hispanic Art Provenance Research
Getty Research Institute, Los Angeles
6 October 2026

UNIVERSITY OF NOTRE DAME

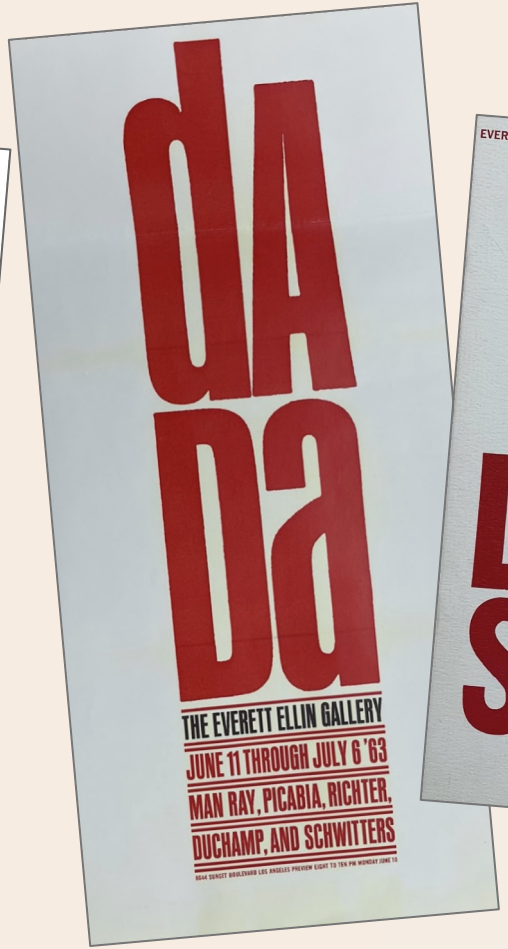
Getty

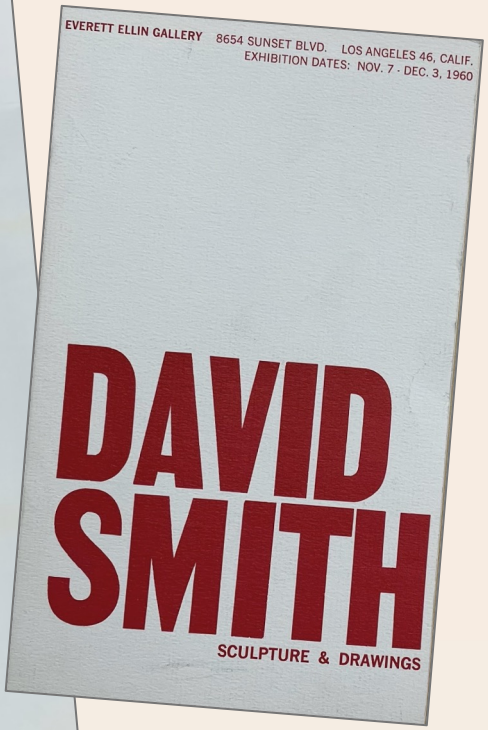


Stendahl Inventory Books (details, various), Stendahl Art Galleries records, 2017.M.38, GRI.

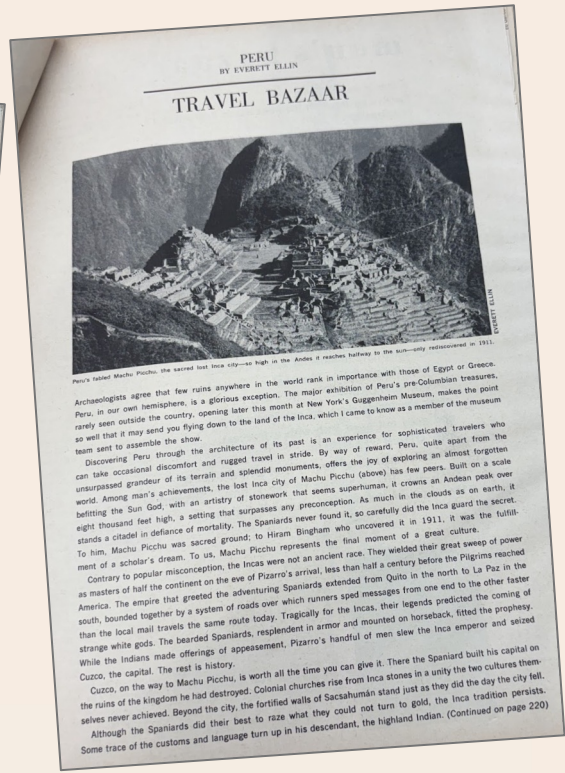


Notebook, Everett Ellin Papers, Box 4, Folder 4, 2015.M.22, GRI.





Everett Ellin Papers, 'Printed Material', Archives of American Art, Smithsonian Institution.



Everett Ellin Papers, Box 5, Folder 3, 2015.M.22, GRI.

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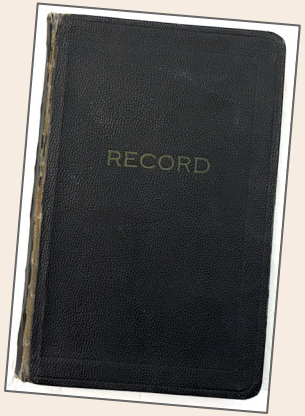
"**Display Ad** 139—no Title." *Los Angeles Times*, 4 December, 1960.

Michael Mathiowetz, "**Galleries and Dealers on La Cienega Blvd, Los Angeles, 1960s.**" In *A "Cocktail and Buffet Supper": The Social Networks of Archaeologists, Institutions, and Pre-Columbian Art Dealers and Collectors in Mid-Century Los Angeles*, PHAPI Symposium, GRI, April 2024.
Including: *Norm's on Fire*, 1964. Ed Ruscha. Oil and pencil on canvas. The Broad, F-RUSC-1P00.04.



- Sidney Janis Gallery (New York)
- André Emmerich Gallery (New York)
- Gordon Ekholm (American Museum of Natural History, New York)
- Karl Nierendorf (New York & Hollywood)
- Et al...

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PERU
BY EVERETT ELLIN

TRAVEL BAZAAR

EVERETT ELLIN

Peru's fabled Machu Picchu, the sacred lost Inca city—so high in the Andes it reaches halfway to the sun—only rediscovered in 1911.

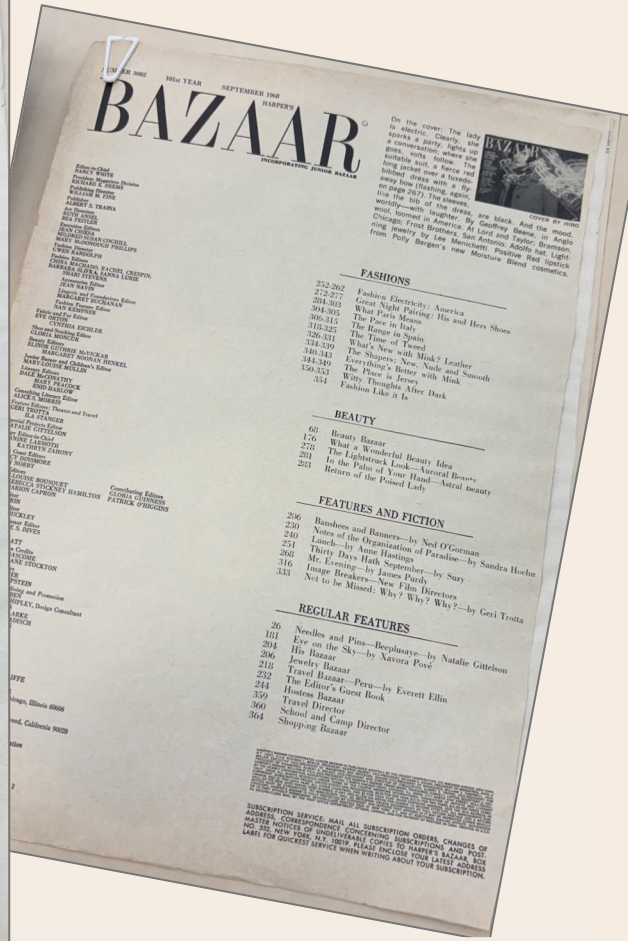
Archaeologists agree that few ruins anywhere in the world rank in importance with those of Egypt or Greece. Peru, in our own hemisphere, is a glorious exception. The major exhibition of Peru's pre-Columbian treasures, rarely seen outside the country, opening later this month at New York's Guggenheim Museum, makes the point so well that it may send you flying down to the land of the Inca, which I came to know as a member of the museum team sent to assemble the show.

Discovering Peru through the architecture of its past is an experience for sophisticated travelers who can take occasional discomfort and rugged travel in stride. By way of reward, Peru, quite apart from the unsurpassed grandeur of its terrain and splendid monuments, offers the joy of exploring an almost forgotten world. Among man's achievements, the lost Inca city of Machu Picchu (above) has few peers. Built on a scale befitting the Sun God, with an artistry of stonework that seems superhuman, it crowns an Andean peak over eight thousand feet high, a setting that surpasses any preconception. As much in the clouds as on earth, it stands a citadel in defiance of mortality. The Spaniards never found it, so carefully did the Inca guard the secret. To him, Machu Picchu was sacred ground; to Hiram Bingham who uncovered it in 1911, it was the fulfillment of a scholar's dream. To us, Machu Picchu represents the final moment of a great culture.

Contrary to popular misconception, the Incas were not an ancient race. They wielded their great sweep of power as masters of half the continent on the eve of Pizarro's arrival, less than half a century before the Pilgrims reached America. The empire that greeted the adventuring Spaniards extended from Quito in the north to La Paz in the south, bounded together by a system of roads over which runners sped messages from one end to the other faster than the local mail travels the same route today. Tragically for the Incas, their legends predicted the coming of strange white gods. The bearded Spaniards, resplendent in armor and mounted on horseback, fitted the prophesy. While the Indians made offerings of appeasement, Pizarro's handful of men slew the Inca emperor and seized Cuzco, the capital. The rest is history.

Cuzco, on the way to Machu Picchu, is worth all the time you can give it. There the Spaniard built his capital on the ruins of the kingdom he had destroyed. Colonial churches rise from Inca stones in a unity the two cultures themselves never achieved. Beyond the city, the fortified walls of Sacsahumán stand just as they did the day the city fell.

Although the Spaniards did their best to raze what they could not turn to gold, the Inca tradition persists. Some trace of the customs and language turn up in his descendant, the highland Indian. (Continued on page 220)



"Travel Bazaar: Peru" in *Harper's Bazaar*, Sept. 1968.
Everett Ellin Papers, Box 5, Folder 3, 2015.M.22, GRI.

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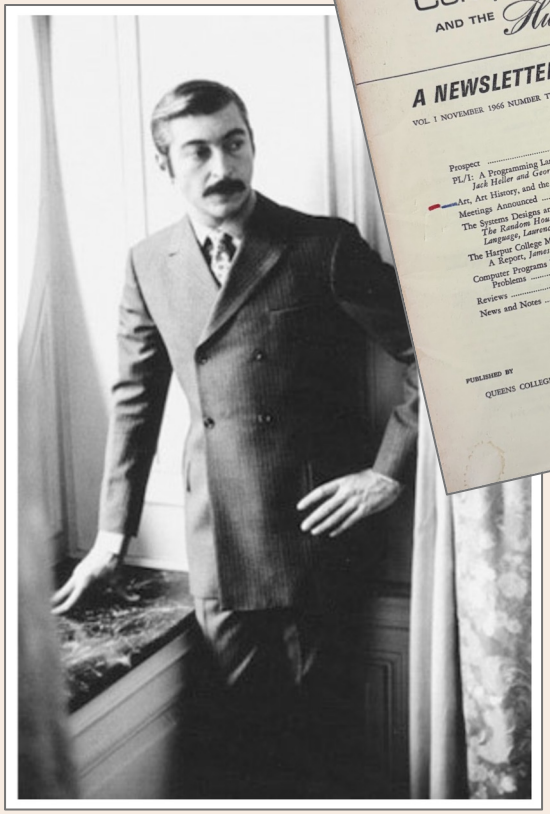
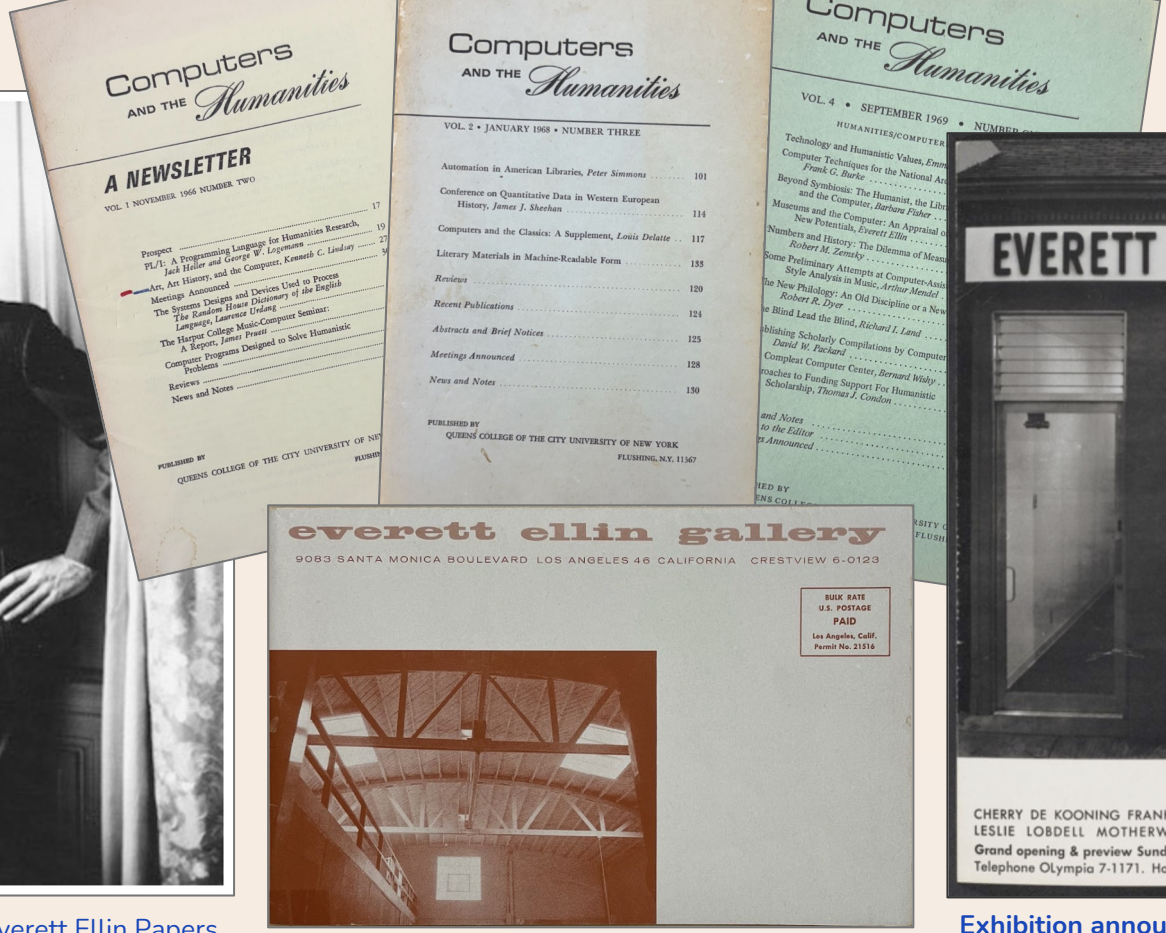


Everett Ellin, c. 1960. Everett Ellin Papers, Archives of American Art, Smithsonian Institution.

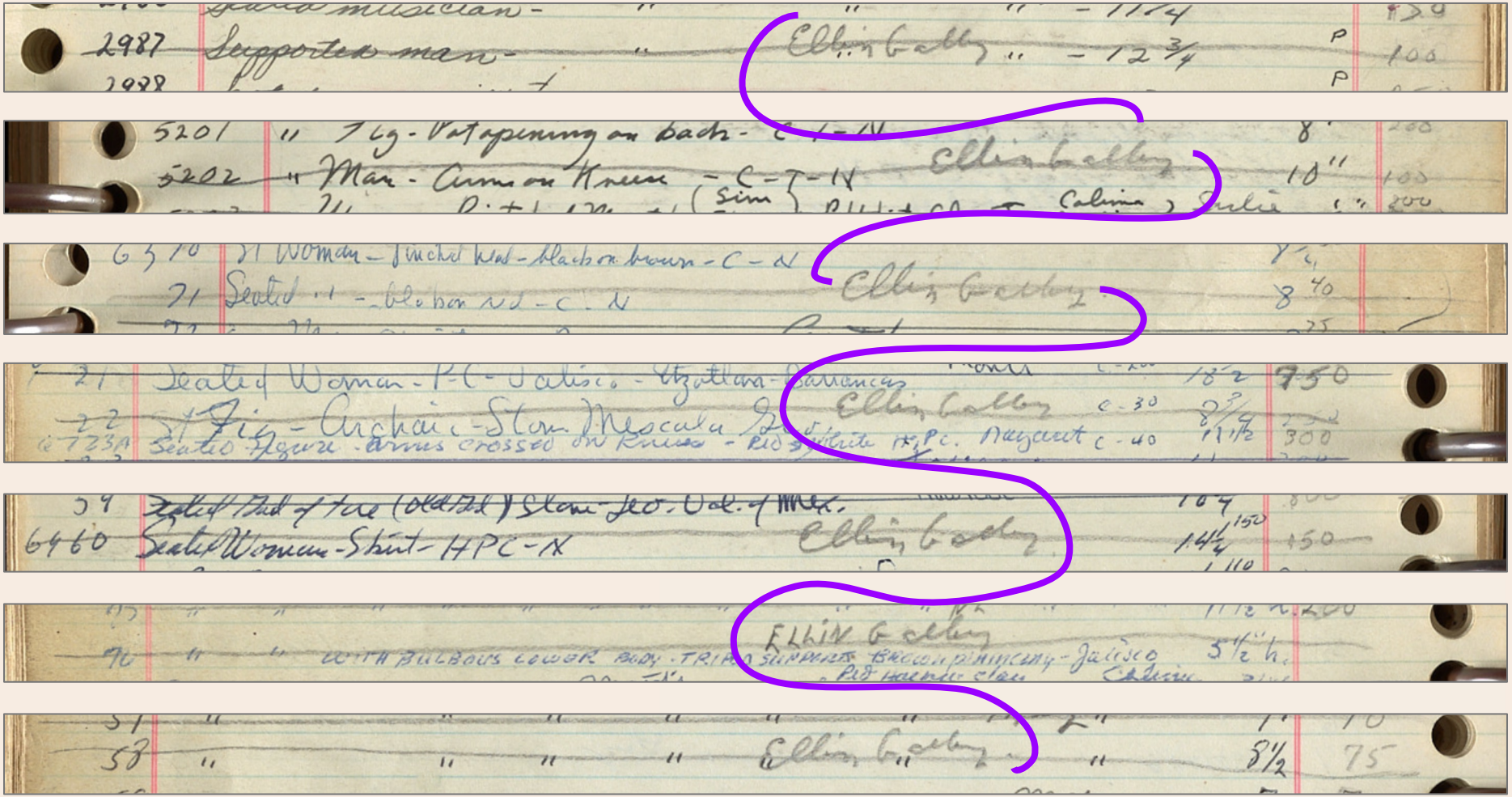


Advertisement for the Everett Ellin Gallery, 1958-59. Everett Ellin Papers, 'Printed Material, 1958-59,' Archives of American Art, Smithsonian Institution.

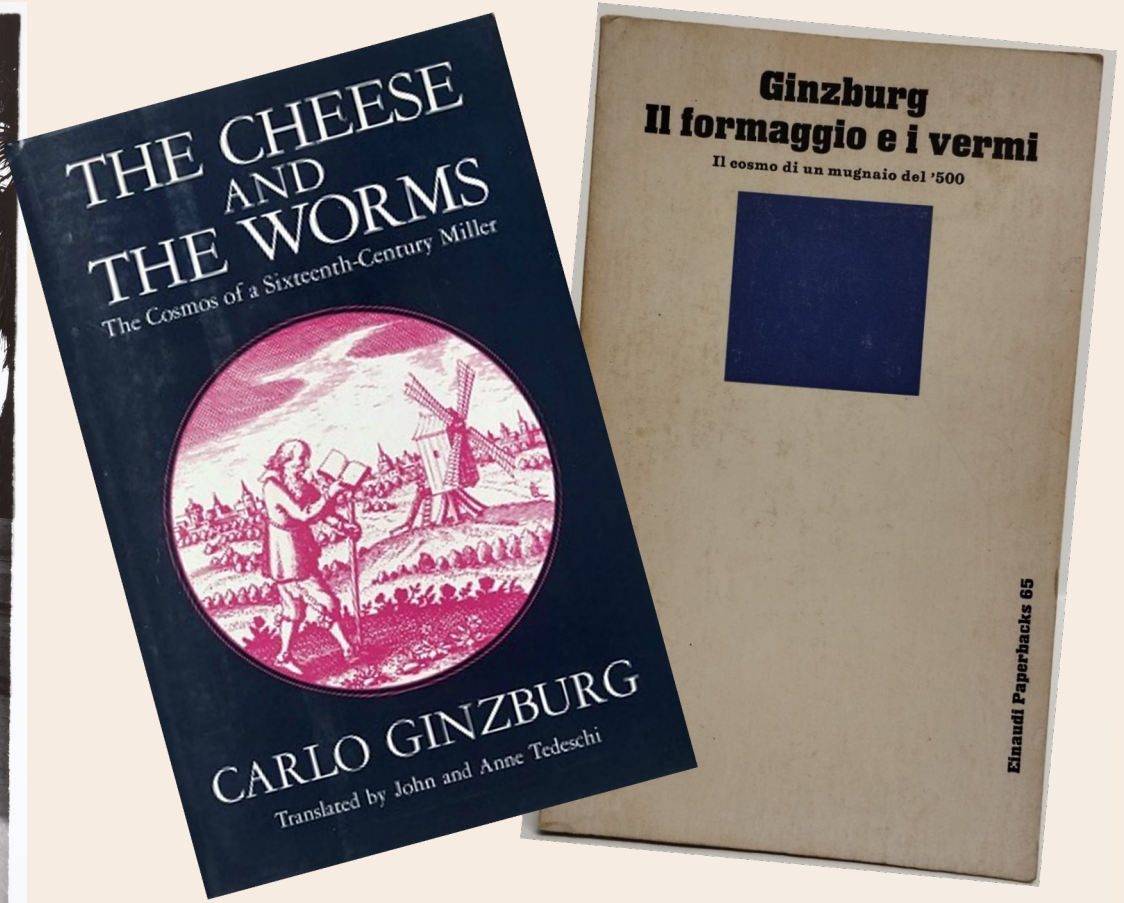
Exhibition announcement for the Everett Ellin Gallery, Inc. inaugural exhibition, 1960. Everett Ellin Papers, 'Printed Material, 1960-61,' Archives of American Art, Smithsonian Institution.

Computers and the Humanities. Everett Ellin Papers, Box 5, Folder 1, 2015.M.22, GRI.

Oral History: *Modern Art in Los Angeles, The Sixties*. December 9-10, 2004, Getty Research Institute. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=x43XPITY7xU>



Stendahl Inventory Books (details, various), Stendahl Art Galleries records, 2017.M.38, GRI.



GRI Scholar Portrait of Carlo Ginzburg, 1994–95.

Special thanks to Alex Cook!

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οὐ γάρ χ[ε for not

Sappho, Anne Carson (trans.), *If Not, Winter: Fragments of Sappho*, New York: Alfred A. Knopf, 2002, poem 61, 126–27.

Códice Maya de México, Grolier pages 1, 2, 3, and 4 with underpainting highlighted in red.
Photos: Enrico Ferorelli; drawings of underpainting: Stephen Houston.

Source: Michael Coe, Mary Miller, Stephen Houston, Karl Taube, “The Fourth Maya Codex,” *Maya Archaeology* 3, San Francisco: Precolumbia Mesoweb Press, 2015, 116–167.

“As the museum in its present form becomes the content of the new electronic environment, we may confidently expect the museum* itself to be transformed into an art form.”

Everett Ellin, “Museums as Media,” *ICA Bulletin*, No. 169, May 1967, 13-15 at 15.

MUSEUMS AS MEDIA

by Everett Ellin
Assistant Director of the Guggenheim Museum, N.Y.

Everett Ellin Papers, Box 5, Folder 3, 2015.M.22, GRI.

*and the archive

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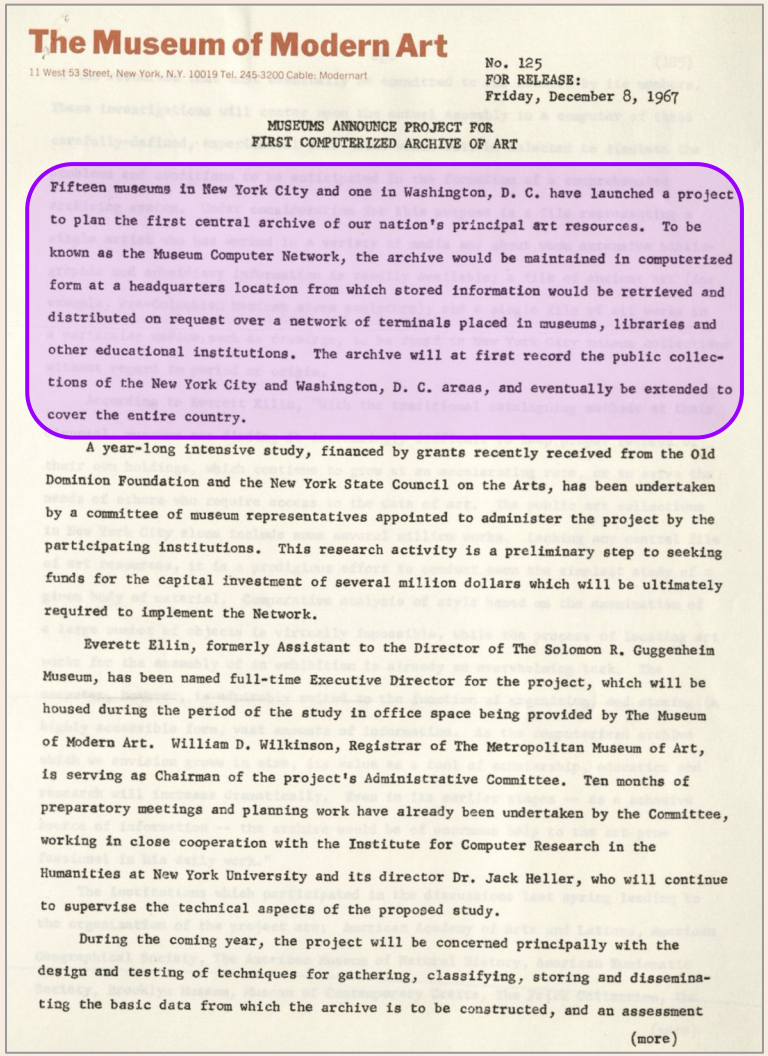


The Museum of Modern Art

11 West 53 Street, New York, N.Y. 10019 Tel. 245-3200 Cable: Modernart

No. 125
FOR RELEASE:
Friday, December 8, 1967

MUSEUMS ANNOUNCE PROJECT FOR
FIRST COMPUTERIZED ARCHIVE OF ART

Fifteen museums in New York City and one in Washington, D. C. have launched a project to plan the first central archive of our nation's principal art resources. To be known as the Museum Computer Network, the archive would be maintained in computerized form at a headquarters location from which stored information would be retrieved and distributed on request over a network of terminals placed in museums, libraries and other educational institutions. The archive will at first record the public collections of the New York City and Washington, D. C. areas, and eventually be extended to cover the entire country.

A year-long intensive study, financed by grants recently received from the Old Dominion Foundation and the New York State Council on the Arts, has been undertaken by a committee of museum representatives appointed to administer the project by the participating institutions. This research activity is a preliminary step to seeking funds for the capital investment of several million dollars which will be ultimately required to implement the Network.

Everett Ellin, formerly Assistant to the Director of The Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum, has been named full-time Executive Director for the project, which will be housed during the period of the study in office space being provided by The Museum of Modern Art. William D. Wilkinson, Registrar of The Metropolitan Museum of Art, is serving as Chairman of the project's Administrative Committee. Ten months of preparatory meetings and planning work have already been undertaken by the Committee, working in close cooperation with the Institute for Computer Research in the Humanities at New York University and its director Dr. Jack Heller, who will continue to supervise the technical aspects of the proposed study.

During the coming year, the project will be concerned principally with the design and testing of techniques for gathering, classifying, storing and disseminating the basic data from which the archive is to be constructed, and an assessment

(more)

MUSEUM
COMPUTER
NETWORK

27 WEST 53 STREET, NEW YORK, N. Y. 10019
TELEPHONE 245-3413 OR 245-3200

- The Metropolitan Museum of Art
- Museum of Primitive Art
- National Museum of the American Indian/Heye Foundation
- Guggenheim Museum
- Whitney Museum of American Art
- Brooklyn Museum
- American Academy of Arts and Letters
- American Geographical Society
- The American Museum of Natural History
- American Numismatic Society
- Museum of Contemporary Crafts
- The Frick Collection
- The Hispanic Society of America
- The Jewish Museum
- National Gallery of Art, Washington, D.C.

Museum Computer Network, 1967-03 - 1969-06. Office of the Director records, RG-02. Brooklyn Museum Archives.

COMPUTERS AND ART

by John J. Clarke

Take a wheel.

When it was first fashioned — probably out of stone — it was kind of homely and somewhat practical. Gradually, the wheel took on a more finished shape and its uses for hauling building materials, weapons, grain or people revolutionized the history of man.

But the creative mind that formed the wheel had other needs — needs for sport, diversion, art. The ox-cart wheel may have come first, but today you're more likely to think of wheels as something under a sleek sports car or stubby wheels to convey a golfcart around a green; maybe even roulette wheels.

Sure it's farfetched. Wheels are still basically used to lighten man's load — but as technology moves many people out of the grind of continuous labor, man's load becomes less a physical thing than an excess of leisure time.

That's about the way it is with computers. Basically the computer was designed to process data rapidly and retrieve information. And the early vacuum tube computers — with memories literally the size of a small room — did just that. Today's solid state, silicon chipped, fully compiled computers do it even better. In the essential areas of food and industrial production, in education, defense, medicine, banking, and communications, the electronic computer is the heart of contemporary systems.

But there's a lighter side to the computer's role of late, a side that's a far cry from the popular view of an omniscient, frigid, calculating machine — it's the creative computer.

Well, not really. But in fields as diverse as cartoons and the classics, music and photography, the computer is playing a new role and, from all reports, enjoying it.

MECHANICAL-ANGELO — THE VISUAL COMPUTER

What happens when you weld the current state of electronic art with traditional art forms? The sounds of progress, widely popularized by the Beatles **Sergeant Pepper,** come screaming, whining, whinnying, and growling out of car radios, transistors, juke boxes and home stereo systems. Join the electronic sound to strobe and black lights, random projected light, light boxes, etc. — and you've got the elements of the psychedelic scene now common throughout the United States, Europe and parts of the East.

Experiments in art and technology seemed a solid enough idea to generate an organization called, aptly enough, Experiments in Art and Technology, Inc. (EAT), formed jointly by artist Robert Rauschenberg and Bell Labs physicist Dr. William Kluver.

The organization put on a show late last year, featuring films covering the computer potential in theater and engineering, a host of sculpture and audio productions in which technology guided the artist's hand, and a computer drawing of a nude. The prospect of mating art and technology has gotten the blessings of the New York State Council on the Arts ($8,000) and $1,000 annual contributions each from industrial patrons such as IBM, ATT, Atlantic Richfield, AFL-CIO, the National Maritime Union, Transport Workers, and Essex Wire.

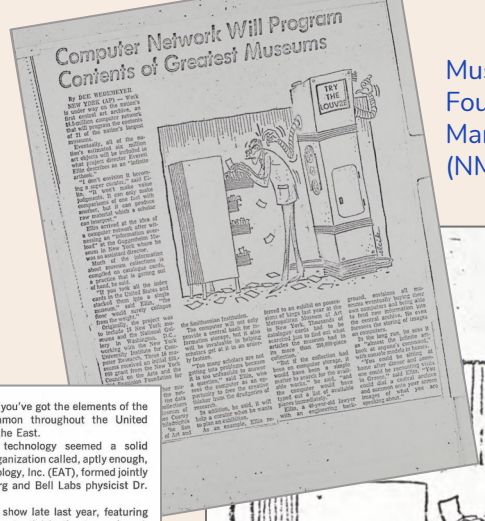
INSTANT ARCHIVES

The museums have been quick to see the computer's potential usage. Fifteen New York City Museums, along with Washington's National Gallery have just launched the Museum Computer Network. The Network is scheduled, within three years, to bank all data from museums in the Northeastern United States — at a cost of $4 million. This central file for art — similar to the Library of Congress file for books — will be, according to Everett Ellin, project director, an indepth archive . . . listing artists, titles, descriptions, and bibliographic references.

"All a teacher lecturing on Greek sculpture would have to do," says Ellin, "is go to a console, dial a code number and have pictures and an arsenal of information about Greek sculpture available the instant it's needed."

Jack Heller, director of New York University's Institute for Computer Research in the Humanities, is supervising the technical end of the project. Heller thinks that computers will produce new Renaissance people. Ever since the Industrial Age began, we have been fragmenting our knowledge in specialized fields. "Once we have worked computers into all fields of the humanities and sciences," he says, "people will have an immense new variety of knowledge, and this will lead

© Computer Usage Company, Inc. 1968


Computer Network Will Program Contents of Greatest Museums

By DEE WEDEMEYER

NEW YORK (AP) — Work is under way on America's most ambitious art archives, an $8 million computer network that will program the contents of 31 of the nation's largest museums.

Eventually, all of the museum's collections, perhaps as many as 2 million art objects will be included in what developers see as "infinite expansion."

"We don't envision it becoming a super computer," said Ellin. "It won't make value judgments. It can only make comparisons, but it can provide a valuable service."

Ellin arrived at the idea of a computer network after witnessing an examination with the Guggenheim Museum in New York, where he was assistant director.

"Much of the information compiled on a particular artist is going on file, but is getting out of hand, he said.

Trying to sift all the index cards in the United States and Europe on a single artist, Ellin said, would "almost require a lifetime."

Originally, the project was to include the New York museums and the National Gallery in Washington, but nothing with the Smithsonian Institute for Museum Research in Washington would be available to scholars and artists.

"The library scholars are not getting data produced because it is too complicated to answer a question," said Ellin, who was the computer consultant to the museum for the Guggenheim show.

In addition, he said, it was difficult for a curator who has only a college degree to plan an exhibit.

As an example, Ellin recalled a curator who was preparing an exhibition of paintings last year at the Guggenheim Museum of Art in New York. Though the curator knew that he wanted to include a certain type of painting, he was unaware that there were 300,000 pieces more than 300,000 pieces of the collection had been produced, because no computer exists to tell him.

Ellin, a graduate of Harvard Law School, said he has been a lawyer, an engineering writer, a museum curator and a museum director. He even served as an exhibit on possible changes that year at the Guggenheim Museum of Art in New York. Though the curator knew that he wanted to include a certain type of painting, he was unaware that there were 300,000 pieces more than 300,000 pieces of the collection had been produced, because no computer exists to tell him.

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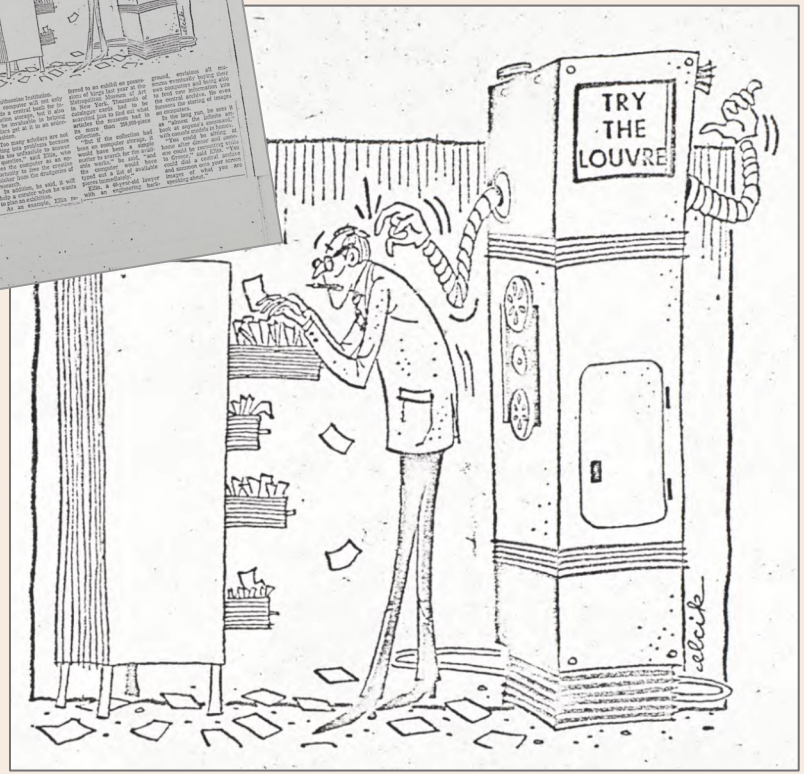


Museum of the American Indian / Heye Foundation Records, Series 8: Collection Management, Box 320, Folder 1 (NMAI.AC.001_320_01).

John J. Clarke, "Computers and Art," *Computer Usage*, Vol. 3, No. 3, Summer 1968, unnumbered.

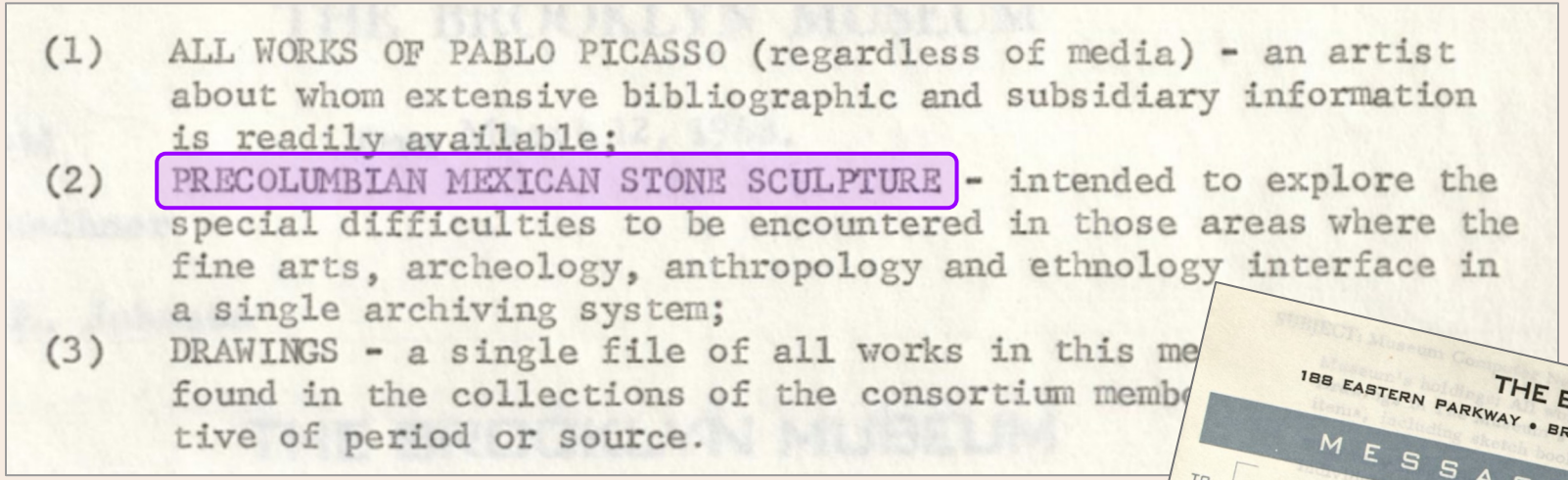
	20th Cent.Sculpture, American	19th Cent.Painting, European	18th Cent.Furniture, American	Pre-columbian Artifacts,Peruvian
American Museum of Natural History				X
The Brooklyn Museum	X	X	X	X
The Frick Collection		X		
The Guggenheim Museum	X	X		X*
The Metropolitan Museum	X	X	X	X
Museum of the American Indian				X
Museum of Modern Art	X	X		
Museum of Primitive Art				X
Museum of the City of New York			X	
The National Gallery		X		
New York Historical Society			X	
Whitney Museum	X			

* Although the Guggenheim Museum's collection does not include any Pre-columbian material, this institution is presenting an exhibition of the ancient art of Peru in October of 1968 which will include some 800 works borrowed from Peruvian lenders.

Above: Everett Ellin to Administrative Committee, “Proposed procedure for the research phase of our study,” November 14, 1967. NMAI.AC.001_320_01.

Top Right: Sawyer, Alan R. *Mastercraftsmen of Ancient Peru*. New York: Solomon R. Guggenheim Foundation, 1968.

Bottom Right: Amanda Brown. “Unpacking Ceramics for *Mastercraftsmen of Ancient Peru*, 1968.” *Articles [online], Guggenheim New York*. April 8, 2011.



(1) ALL WORKS OF PABLO PICASSO (regardless of media) - an artist about whom extensive bibliographic and subsidiary information is readily available;

(2) PRECOLUMBIAN MEXICAN STONE SCULPTURE - intended to explore the special difficulties to be encountered in those areas where the fine arts, archeology, anthropology and ethnology interface in a single archiving system;

(3) DRAWINGS - a single file of all works in this me
found in the collections of the consortium membe
tive of period or source.

THE BROOKLYN MUSEUM

188 EASTERN PARKWAY • BROOKLYN, NEW YORK 11238

MESSAGE

TO TSB

DATE March 13, 1968

The Museum Computer Network program outlined in the letter from E. Ellin, Feb. 29 involves this department for the Mexican Stone Sculpture category. We will be glad to help and I'm sure we can find some of the "special difficulties they want to explore. The Registrar would seem the logical person to be in charge of this project.

BY

"The parameters of these data files have been defined with a view towards **involving each consortium member** in this critical phase of the project...to insure that the procedures and standards now devised for future use reflect a **cross-section of professional experience**. Perhaps more importantly, we should strive to encourage from the very beginning the **spirit of institutional interaction** indispensable to the establishment of a central archive of museum collections."

Museum Computer Network, 1967-03 - 1969-06. Office of the Director records, RG-02. Brooklyn Museum Archives.

Museum of the American Indian / Heye Foundation Records, Series 8: Collection Management, Box 320, Folder 1 (NMAI.AC.001_320_01).

23
5833

MUSEUM COMPUTER NETWORK DATA SHEET FOR THE MEXICAN SCULPTURE COLLECTION OF THE MUSEUM OF THE AMERICAN INDIAN / HEYE FOUNDATION
August 1968

Page 1

1	The Museum of the American Indian / Heye Foundation 2 New York, N. Y.	4
2	Sculpture 36 ~~xxxxxxx~~ Stone 48 Mexico	76
3	Museum number: MIAI 23 /// 5833	6
	Description:	
4	Type: Figurine	
5	Function:	
6	Material or technique: Clay	
7	" " "	
8	Size & wt.	
9	Remarks: Tiny clay female figurine.	
10	(cont.)	
11	Primary inscriptions	
12	(cont.)	
	Representation:	
13	Person or diety	
14	Other subject: Woman	
15	Decorative motif	
	Provenance:	
16	Area	
18	State: Guanajuato	
19	Locality	
20	Site	
21	Expedition	
22	Collector	
23	Season	
24	Remarks	

23
5833

MUSEUM COMPUTER NETWORK DATA SHEET FOR THE MEXICAN SCULPTURE COLLECTION OF THE MUSEUM OF THE AMERICAN INDIAN / HEYE FOUNDATION
August 1968

Page 2

80

	Origins:	
1	Period	
2	Culture	
3	Style	
4	Remarks	
5	(cont.)	
6	Minimum date: N.B. I'll need some guide lines for max. & min. dates.	
7	Date	
8	Maximum date	
	Source and History:	
9	Acquisition: Purchased from Monique Grant # 424.	
10	(cont.)	
11	2nd credit	
12	Donor or lender	
13	Vendor: Grant, Monique	
14	History of ownership	
15	(cont.)	
16	Year of acq.	
	Documentation:	
17	Photo(s)	
18	References	
19	(N.B. Please	
20	insert code number 95 in the right-	
21	hand column at the end of	
22	each separate reference.)	
23		

MUSEUM
COMPUTER
NETWORK

COMPUTER

97 WEST 53 STREET, NEW YORK, N. Y. 10019
TELEPHONE 245-3413 OR 245-3200

EVERETT ELLIN, EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR
ADMINISTRATIVE COMMITTEE
CHAIRMAN, WILLIAM D. WILKINSON
THE METROPOLITAN MUSEUM OF ART
ALLAN D. CHAPMAN
THE MUSEUM OF PRIMITIVE ART
FREDERICK J. DOCKSTADER
MUSEUM OF THE AMERICAN INDIAN, HEYE FOUNDATION
EVERETT ELLIN
RICHARD H. KOCH
THE MUSEUM OF MODERN ART

July 29, 1968

Dr. Frederick J. Dockstader, Director
The Museum of the American Indian
Broadway at 155 Street
New York, N. Y. 10032

Dear Dr. Dockstader:

I enclose three xerox copies of the data sheet I propose to use in preparing your museum's records for keypunching. Two samples have been completed with information for the cards you gave me. This is based upon the one I designed for the MPA, which you have seen. But I've tried to arrange data in order corresponding to your cards. Single spacing has been virtually abandoned as we find it slows the keypunch operation.

Please feel free to suggest any change, however sweeping (or trivial) that you think might improve this form in any way. When we've agreed upon what seems the best possible format, I'll get an edition printed. It would probably be wisest not to order enough for the whole 10 or 15 thousand works right away, we may want to change something later. Perhaps two or three thousand for a start. I doubt that I can manage even that many in the time I'll be up there.

This will confirm that I'm planning to work there August 6-9 (starting Tuesday because I understand you're closed Monday) and one other week, to be arranged. What time do you start work?

Yours very truly,

David Vance
Registrar

DV:eg

encl.

MUSEUM DATA BANK COORDINATING COMMITTEE

Dr. Robert G. Chenhall
Executive Director

University of Arkansas Museum
Fayetteville, Arkansas 72701
(501)575-2450

Reginald Creighton
Information Systems Division
Smithsonian Institution

Dr. Richard H. Foote
Agricultural Research Service
U. S. Dept. of Agriculture

Dr. Jack Heller
Dept. of Computer Science
SUNY at Stony Brook

Dr. William Klein
Missouri Botanical Garden

Harriet Krauss
Computer Consultant

Dr. James F. Mello
National Museum of Natural History
Smithsonian Institution

Frederick Schmid
Office of Museum Programs
Smithsonian Institution

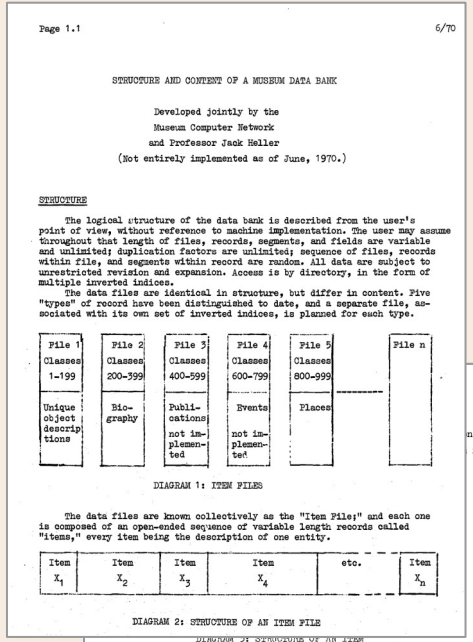
Dr. David Scott
National Gallery of Art

Stanwyn Shetler
National Museum of Natural History
Smithsonian Institution

Holman J. Swinney
Margaret Woodbury Strong Museum

David Vance
Museum Computer Network, Inc.
Museum of Modern Art

what is the museum data bank coordinating committee ? ? ?



Page 1.1 6/70

STRUCTURE AND CONTENT OF A MUSEUM DATA BANK

Developed jointly by the
Museum Computer Network
and Professor Jack Heller
(Not entirely implemented as of June, 1970.)

STRUCTURE

The logical structure of the data bank is described from the user's point of view, without reference to machine implementation. The user may assume throughout that length of files, records, segments, and fields are variable and unlimited; duplication factors are unlimited; sequence of files, records within file, and segments within record are random. All data are subject to unrestricted revision and expansion. Access is by directory, in the form of multiple inverted indices.

The data files are identical in structure, but differ in content. Five "types" of record have been distinguished to date, and a separate file, associated with its own set of inverted indices, is planned for each type.

File 1	File 2	File 3	File 4	File 5	File n
Classes 1-199	Classes 200-399	Classes 400-599	Classes 600-799	Classes 800-999	
Unique object descriptions	Biography	Publications not implemented	Events not implemented	Places	

DIAGRAM 1: ITEM FILES

The data files are known collectively as the "Item File;" and each one is composed of an open-ended sequence of variable length records called "items," every item being the description of one entity.

Item X_1	Item X_2	Item X_3	Item X_4	etc.	Item X_n

DIAGRAM 2: STRUCTURE OF AN ITEM FILE

Page 1.2 1/71

Supersedes page 1. 2 dated 6/70

The individual item is subdivided into a series of segments known as "units." There may be any number of these, and they may be listed in any order. There are three separate kinds of unit:

1. Identifier(s).
   There must be at least one identifier in every item, and no identifier may be duplicated within the data bank or within the entire set of Museum Computer Network data banks. The identifiers will be indexed and will serve as ultimate tie-breakers in all sorting operations. They are the "targets" of links between items.

2. Indexed descriptors.
   An indexed descriptor consists of a word, phrase, or number conveying one fact about the described entity. Arbitrarily all indexed descriptors have been assigned even annotation class numbers, signifying* intent to construct an inverted index for the class. The identifier may be considered a special indexed descriptor.

3. Free text.
   A free text unit consists of information in any form, conveying a set of related facts about the described entity. All free text units have been assigned odd annotation numbers, showing that there is no intent to construct an inverted index for the class.

Several of the free text annotation classes are paired with a corresponding indexed descriptor class, which serves as an index to the free text, where both occur in a single item.

Any indexed annotation class except that of the identifier may be repeated as often as needed in a single item, and the occurrences need not be consecutive. Free text annotation classes may also be repeated within the item for reasons of convenience. However, there is no logical reason for maintaining such separation, so all free text strings with the same number will normally be concatenated when an item is retrieved.

The distinction between a unitary fact and a cluster of facts is, of course, arbitrary, since any factual statement can be replaced by a set of more specific statements ad infinitum. By the word "fact," I mean here whatever can be communicated by one indexible descriptor combined with an annotator; and by "indexible" I mean a character string that (in its sort string form) is likely to be used as a criterion for selective retrieval and/or sorting. This likelihood remains a matter of subjective judgment. A mistaken judgment would not be serious, however, since inverted indices can be constructed for odd numbered classes.

*No indices have yet been constructed as of January 1971.

Units within an Item are divided into fields, at least three of which are mandatory.

Gen. code	Annotation number	Display string	Sort string	Part identifier or qualifier	Source list	Poin
Mandatory fields			Conditionally mandatory	Not implemented		

DIAGRAM 4: STRUCTURE OF A UNIT

The generation code, under system control, indicates the number of updated versions of the unit that have been entered subsequent to this version. Current data is identified by generation code 0. Annotation numbers place each unit in a particular annotation class. The display string contains the exact text image to be printed or otherwise displayed when the unit is retrieved.

The sort string, for internal use only, substitutes for the display string when an indexed descriptor is used for matching or sorting. In most cases the sort string can be generated by changing all capital letters to lower case, omitting punctuation and special characters, and squeezing out multiple blanks. These "normal" sort strings are derived from the display string as needed and are not stored. Where a normal sort string would not produce the desired sorting sequence, a special one is generated at input time and stored permanently with the unit.

The part identification is used when a descriptor applies, not to the described entity as a whole, but only to some named part of it. In an identifier

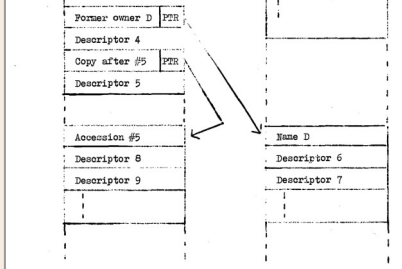


DIAGRAM 5: RELATIONSHIPS AMONG ITEMS

* See Appendix 1.

Museum of the American Indian / Heye Foundation Records, Series 8: Collection Management, Box 320, Folder 3 (NMAI.AC.001_320_03).

Selected pages from: David Vance and Jack Heller, *Structure and Content of a Museum Data Bank*, compiled for use in connection with "A Workshop on Data Collection and Data Dissemination in Museums" at the Metropolitan Museum of Art, June 5, 1970 (Revised July 1970 and January 1971). ERIC.

16== Expedition.
The name only of the expedition which excavated or collected the object.
Include the year if necessary for identification.

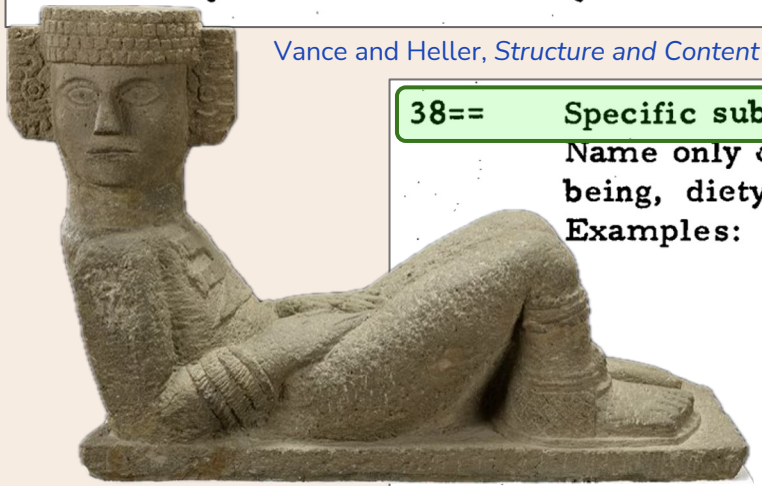
17== Remarks about the expedition.

18== Excavator or collector.
The name only of the person who excavated or collected the object.

19== Remarks about the excavator or collector.

20== Season.
The year in which the object was collected or excavated.

Vance and Heller, *Structure and Content of a Museum Data Bank*, pp. 13 (above), 15 (below).



Chacmool [fake], 20th century. Unidentified artist. Minneapolis Institute of Art, 47.2.48.

38== Specific subject(s) (proper noun).
Name only of a real person, fictional character, mythological being, diety, animal, ship, event or place represented.
Examples:
- Man-o-War.
- Charles V.
- Dr. Gachet.
- St. Dunstan.
- Chocmool.
- Santa Claus.
- U. S. S. Maine.
- Toledo Spain.
- The e of Bunker Hill.

Above: **Santa Claus Studies**, 1962. Jim Dine. Metropolitan Museum of Art, 1995.516.2.

Left: **Roundel with Saint Dunstan of Canterbury**, 1510–20. South Netherlandish. Metropolitan Museum of Art, 32.24.51.

76== Country of origin.
The name of a modern state associated with the origin of the object, whether by nationality or birthplace of the artist, national school or style, site of discovery or any other connection.
Examples: - United States.
- The Netherlands
- Great Britain.
- Mexico.
- Canada.

176== Site number.

78== Place of origin.
The name of any geographical place, other than a modern stat
name (class 76), associated in any way with the origin or di
covery of the object. Include state and country if necessary
identification.
Examples: - Burgundy.
- State of Mexico.
- Venice.
- Sepik River.
- Peoria Bottom, South Dakota.
- Guadalajara, Mexico.
- Knossos.

178== Intra-site provenience.

79== Remarks about the place of origin.

80== Culture or period.
The name only of any recognized period, epoch, horizon, culture, subculture, tribal group, style or school.
Examples: - Aztec.
- Early Minoan.
- Federal.
- Impressionist.
- Magdalenian.
- Neo-Classic.
- Pre-Columbian.
- Timurid.
- Zuni.

180== Cultural classification.

181== Evidence for cultural classification.

81== Remarks about the culture or period.

Vance and Heller, *Structure and Content of a Museum Data Bank*, pp. 21 (left), 22 (right).

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Pages A2.13 - A2.16 dated 7/70 replace pages A2.13 - A2.14 dated 6/70.

LOCATION DATA: Annotation classes 800-999
Note: Prepared in collaboration with Robert G. Chenhall of the Arkansas Archeological Survey.

802== The name only of the institution supplying this data.

804== The name only of the recording station.

806== Site number.
Note: Corresponds to content of class 176 in the records of objects from the site.

906== Reporter's site number.

808== County.
The county in which the site is located.

810== Drainage
The drainage on which the site is located.

812== Map coordinates.
Record in sequence and separated by commas: Township, Range, Section, 1/4 Section, 11/44 Section, 111/444 Section. If the finer sub-divisions are not known, record as much as is available. This information will be used for the creation of the Global Reference Code number.

813== Instructions for reaching site.
Explain as briefly as possible how to get to the site. Cite permanent landmarks wherever possible.

816== Reporter.
The name of the individual reporting the site.

817== Reporter's address.
The mailing address of the individual named in class 816.

818== Recorder.
The name of the individual preparing the site survey form.

819== Recorder's address.
The address of the individual named in class 818.

820== Date of survey.
The day, month, and year when the survey was taken. Record in the form "dd/mm/yr". If only part of the information is known, leave blank spaces.

Pages A2.13 - A2.16 dated 7/70 replace pages A2.13 - A2.14 dated 6/70.

830== Site name.
The principal or best known name by which the site is identified.

930== Other name(s) for the site. Any other names by which the site either has been known in the past or is now known.

832== Site category.
A brief (two or three word) description of the general characteristics of the site.
Examples: - Bluff Shelter.
- Late Archaic Mound(s).
- Temple Mound.

835== General description.
A more detailed, textual description of the site. Do not duplicate information that is covered in other classes, such as county (class 808), drainage (class 810), etc., but do include any data pertinent to the orientation, slope, size, floral surroundings, topographic associations or other features appropriate to a verbal description of the site.

839== Previous excavations or collections.
If individuals or institutions are known to have collections from this site, or if there has been work done at the site previously, briefly describe what is known.
Examples: - Reference by Moore 1908: 328.
- Excavated by UOA Field School 1964.
- Collection owned by John Doe.

840== Cultural classification.
Two or more words as necessary to describe the phase and/or the culture represented at this site.

841== Authority for cultural classification.
Normally, authority for a cultural classification will include both a brief listing of the diagnostic traits (e.g., pottery types or point types) and the published reference which associates this combination of traits with the particular cultural terms used in class 840.

842== Developmental stage.
Technological stages represented at the site. May or may not be firmly placed geographically and temporally (See class 840).
Examples: - Late Archaic.
- Middle Mississippian.

843== Authority for developmental stage classification. See 841.

Vance and Heller, *Structure and Content of a Museum Data Bank*, pp. 27 (left) 28 (right).

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23
5839

Male clay figurine. From Cuenca de Balsa.

La Barca
Jalisco
Mexico

Purchased from Monique Grant #420

CHECKED
1966

OVER

MEXICAN PRECOLUMBIAN

#1 - PAIR OF CHUPICUARO DANCER CONTORTIONISTS 250
#2 - DOUBLE CHUPICUARO - FIGURE CARRYING CRIPPLE 150
3 - POLICHROME " FIGURE 150
4 - CHUPICUARO FIGURE WITH FANCY HAIR 100
- CHUPICUARO SHELL FIGURE 50
LA BARCA, JALISCO FEMALE FIGURE cuenca de balsa 100
#406 - CHUPICUARO PAIR 120
CHUPICUARO MINIATURE POLICHROME FIGURE 20
" FIGURE 45
" PREGNANT FIGURE 50
HUPICUARO STONE GRASSHOPPER 60
UPICUARO FIGURE 20
" " 20
" " 25
RERO STONE FIG (TEOTIHUACAN & OLMEC INFLUENCE) 225
426 " GOLD EARRINGS 230
*FOUND TOGETHER 427 MICHOACAN TWEEZERS WITH FABRIC 185
420 - LA BARCA, JALISCO MALE FIGURE 75
*FOUND TOGETHER 428 - JADE CIRCLES WITH COPPER TRIM (9) 225
429 - CHINESCO BOWL - NAYARIT 75
419 - JALISCO NECKLACE OF 23 MINIATURE FIGURES 200
2375
AMOUNT TO BE PAYED $2000
IN FALL OF 1965

Left and Middle: National Museum of the American Indian, online record, catalog no. 23/5839.
Right: National Museum of the American Indian, Invoice no. 0105, 1965 (courtesy of Maria Galban).

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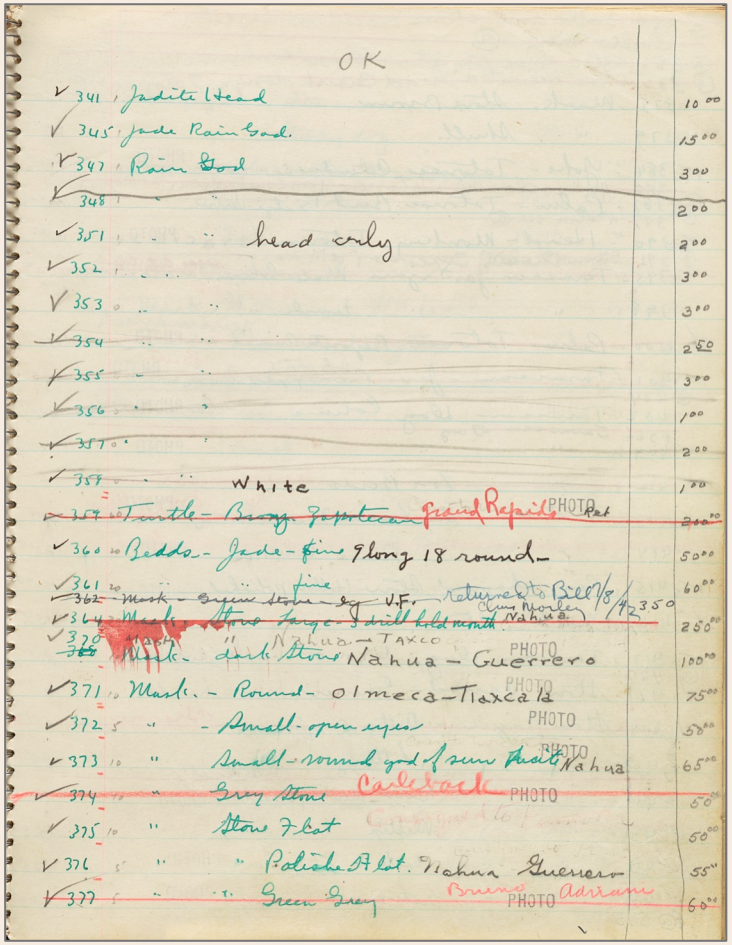

Inventory Book 1, Page 13, Stendahl Art Galleries records, Box 91, Folder 6, 2017.M.38, GRI.

Verbatim Object Description	Verbatim Location(s)	Locale	Region	Country	Verbatim Culture(s)	Culture(s)
Jadite Head						
Jade Rain God.						
Rain God						
ditto [Rain God]						
ditto [Rain God];; head only						
ditto [Rain God]						
ditto [Rain God]						
ditto [Rain God]						
ditto [Rain God]						
ditto [Rain God]						
ditto [Rain God]						
ditto [Rain God];; White						
Turtle - Bronz. Zapotecan;; Grand Rapids;; [erased]Cons to worcester[/erased];; Ret					Zapotecan	Oaxaca; Zapotec/Bene Zaa
Beads - Jade - Fine;; 9 long 18 round-						
ditto [Beads - Jade] fine						
Mask - Green Stone -;; lg V.F.;; returned to Bill 7/8/42						
Mass - Stone Large - 3 drill bold mouth;; Chas Morley;; Nahua;; [erased]cons to worcester[/erased]					Nahuas	Central Mexico; Nahua
ditto [Mask Stone] Nahua - TAXCO [erased]cons to Pomona[/erased]	TAXCO	Taxco	State of Guerrero	Mexico	Nahua	Central Mexico; Nahua
Mask - dark Stone;; Nahua - Guerrero	Guerrero		State of Guerrero	Mexico	Nahua	Guerrero; Nahua
Mask. - Round -;; Olmeca - Tlaxcala	Tlaxcala		State of Tlaxcala	Mexico	Olmeca	Olmec style
ditto [Mask] - Small - open eyes —						
ditto [Mask] Small - round god of sun Lucite;; Nahua;; [erased]cons. to worcester[/erased]					Nahua	Central Mexico; Nahua
ditto [Mask] Grey Stone;; Carleback						
ditto [Mask] Stone Flat;; [erased]Consigned to Pomona[/erased]						
ditto [Mask Stone] Polished Flat.;; Nahua Guerrero;; [erased]consigned to worcester[/erased]	Guerrero		State of Guerrero	Mexico	Nahua	Guerrero; Nahua
ditto [Mask Stone] Green Grey;; Bruno Adriani						

Transcribed and parsed data from Inventory Book 1, Page 13, Stendahl Art Galleries records, Box 91, Folder 6, 2017.M.38, GRI.

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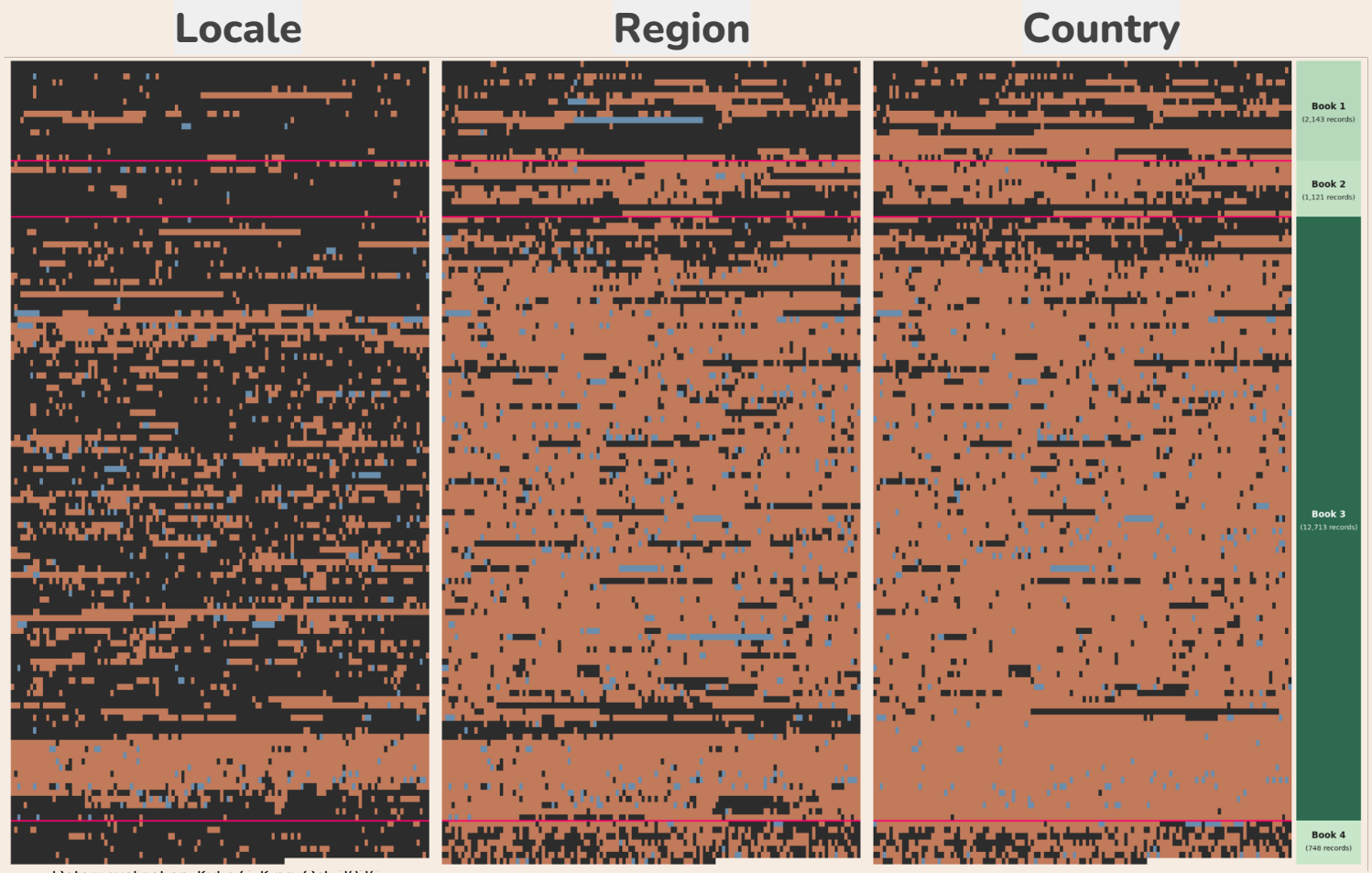
Location Data in Stendahl Inventory Books



Absences

Locale
12,222
(73.1%)

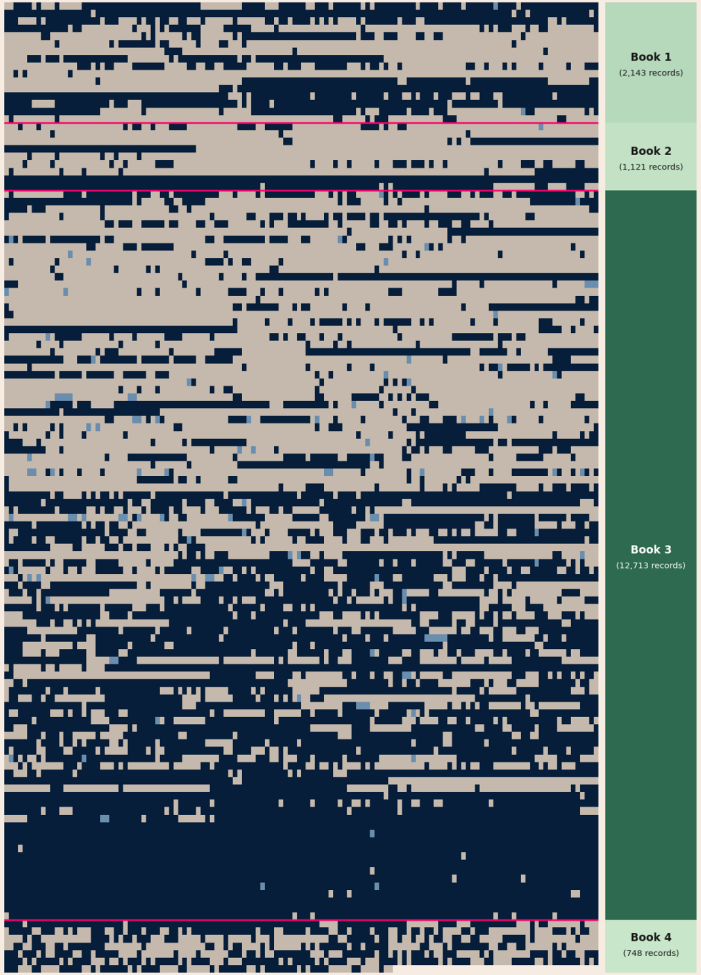
Region
4,974
(29.7%)

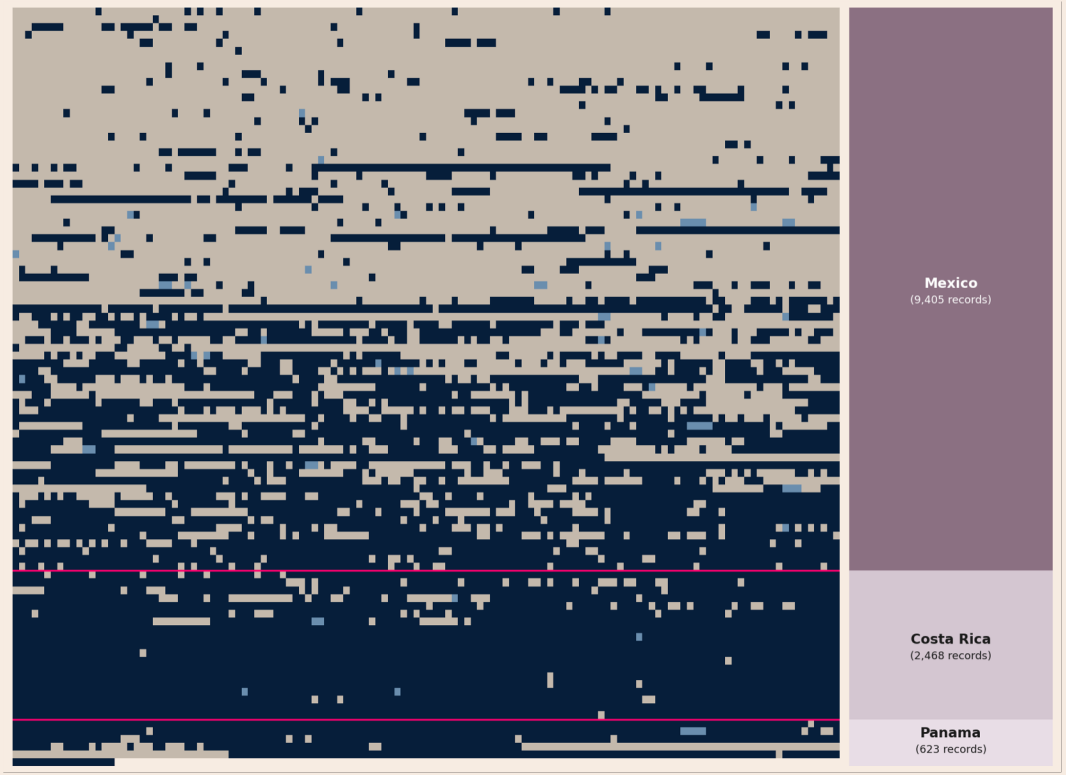
Country
3,453
(20.6%)

- Absent
- Ambiguous
- Present

Data visualization: Kylie G. King, Oct. 2026.
Data source: Stendahl Art Galleries Inventory Books Transcriptions, Getty Research Institute, Los Angeles (2017.M.38), 2026.

Culture Data in Stendahl Inventory Books





Absent
8,128
(48.6%)

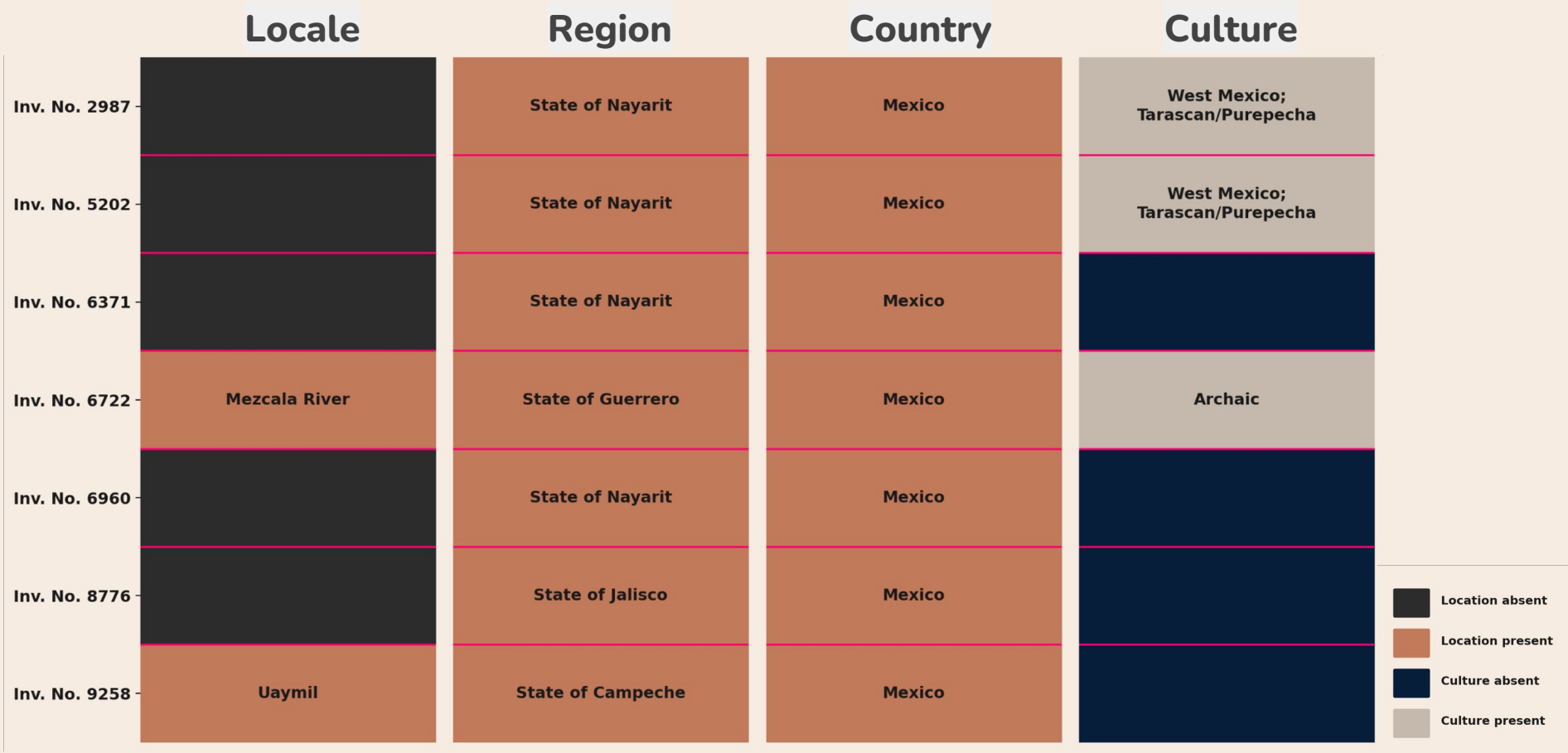
Ambiguous
113
(0.7%)

Present
8,484
(50.7%)

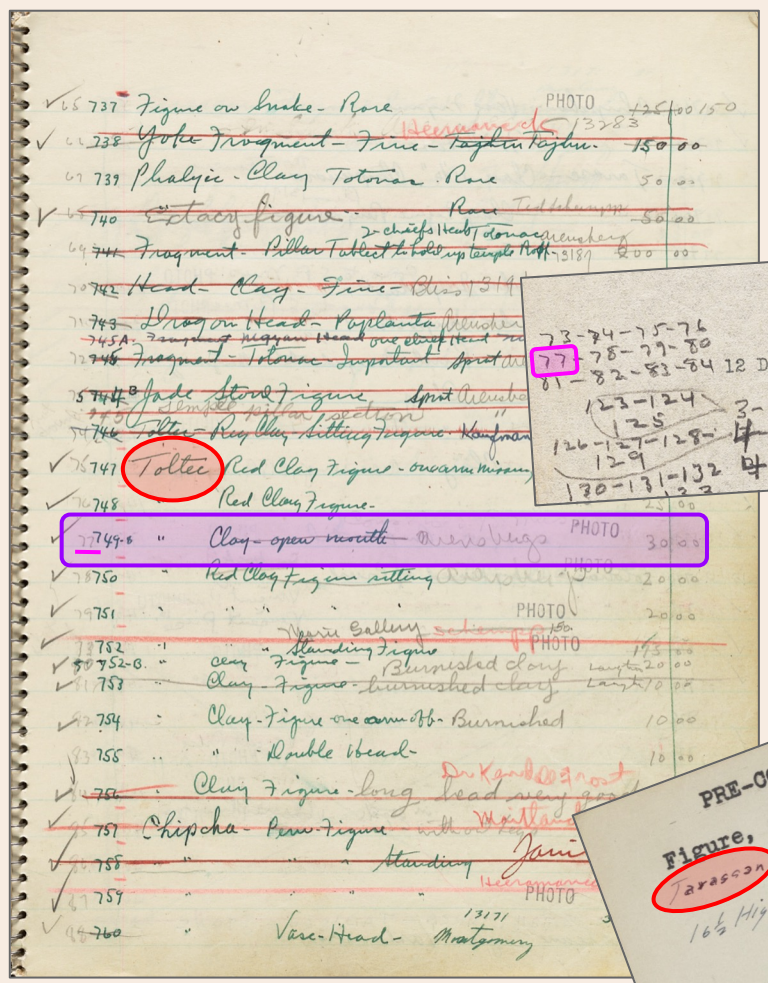
Absent
Ambiguous
Present

Data visualizations: Kylie G. King, Oct. 2026.
Data source: Stendahl Art Galleries Inventory Books Transcriptions, Getty Research Institute, Los Angeles (2017.M.38), 2026.

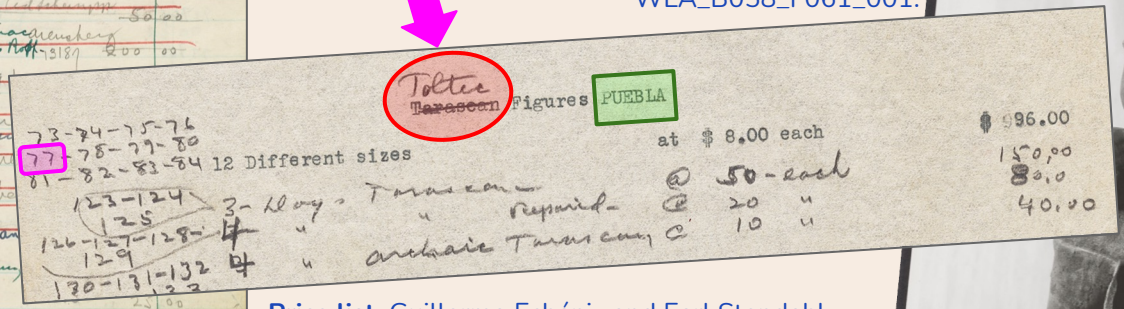
Ellin's Objects in Stendahl Inventory Books



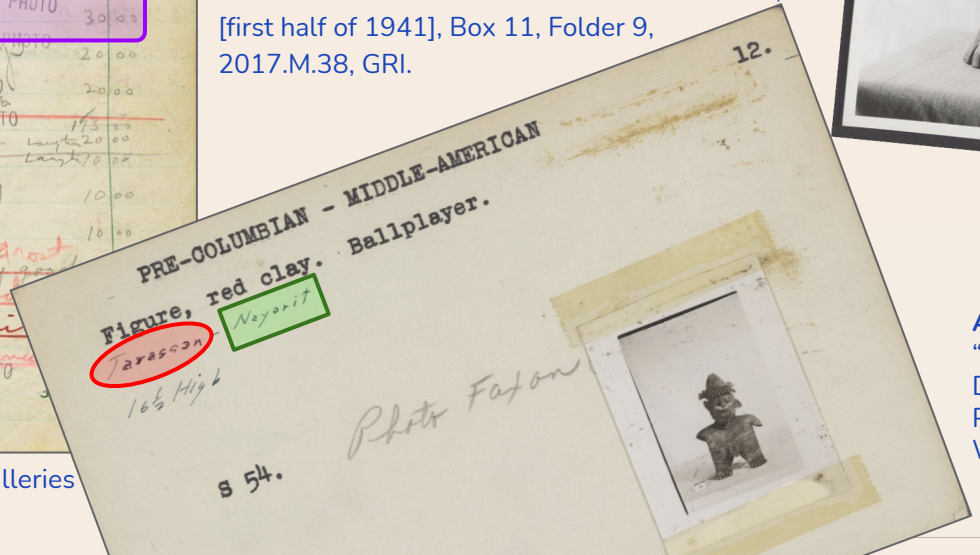
Data visualization: Kylie G. King, April 2026.
Data source: Stendahl Art Galleries Inventory Books Transcriptions, Getty Research Institute, Los Angeles (2017.M.38), 2026.


737 Figure on Snake - Rare PHOTO
738 Yoke Fragment - Fine - Tajin Tajin
739 Phallic - Clay Totonac Rare
740 Ecstacy figure - Rare
741 Fragment - Pillar Tablet
742 Head - Clay - Fine
743 Drag on Head - Poplanta
745A Fragment - Totonac Important
746 Jade Stone figure
747 Toltec Red Clay figure
748 Red Clay figure
749-B " Clay - open necklace PHOTO
750 " Red Clay figure sitting
751 " " " PHOTO
752 " Standing figure PHOTO
752-B. " " figure - Burnished clay
753 " Clay - figure - burnished clay
754 " Clay - figure one arm off - Burnished
755 " " - Double Head -
756 " Clay figure - long head
757 Chipcha - Peru - figure
758 " " " standing
759 " " " PHOTO
760 " Vase - Head -

Inventory Book 1, Page 25. Stendahl Art Galleries records, Box 91, Folder 6, 2017.M.38, GRI.


Toltec Tarascan Figures PUEBLA
73-74-75-76
77 78-79-80
81-82-83-84 12 Different sizes at $ 8.00 each $ 96.00
123-124 3- Clay - Tarascan @ 50 - each 150.00
125 " Reproduction @ 20 " 80.00
126-127-128-129 4 " archaic Tarascan @ 10 " 40.00
130-131-132 3 "

Price list. Guillermo Echániz and Earl Stendahl, [first half of 1941], Box 11, Folder 9, 2017.M.38, GRI.


12.
PRE-COLUMBIAN - MIDDLE-AMERICAN
Figure, red clay. Ballplayer.
Nayarit
Tarascan
16½ High
Photo Faxon
S 54.

Arensberg catalog card for "Red clay man" figure, Duchamp Research Portal, Philadelphia Museum of Art, WLA_B025_F001_151.

"Red clay man" owned by Walter and Louise Arensberg. Photograph by Floyd Faxon. Duchamp Research Portal, Philadelphia Museum of Art, WLA_B058_F061_001.

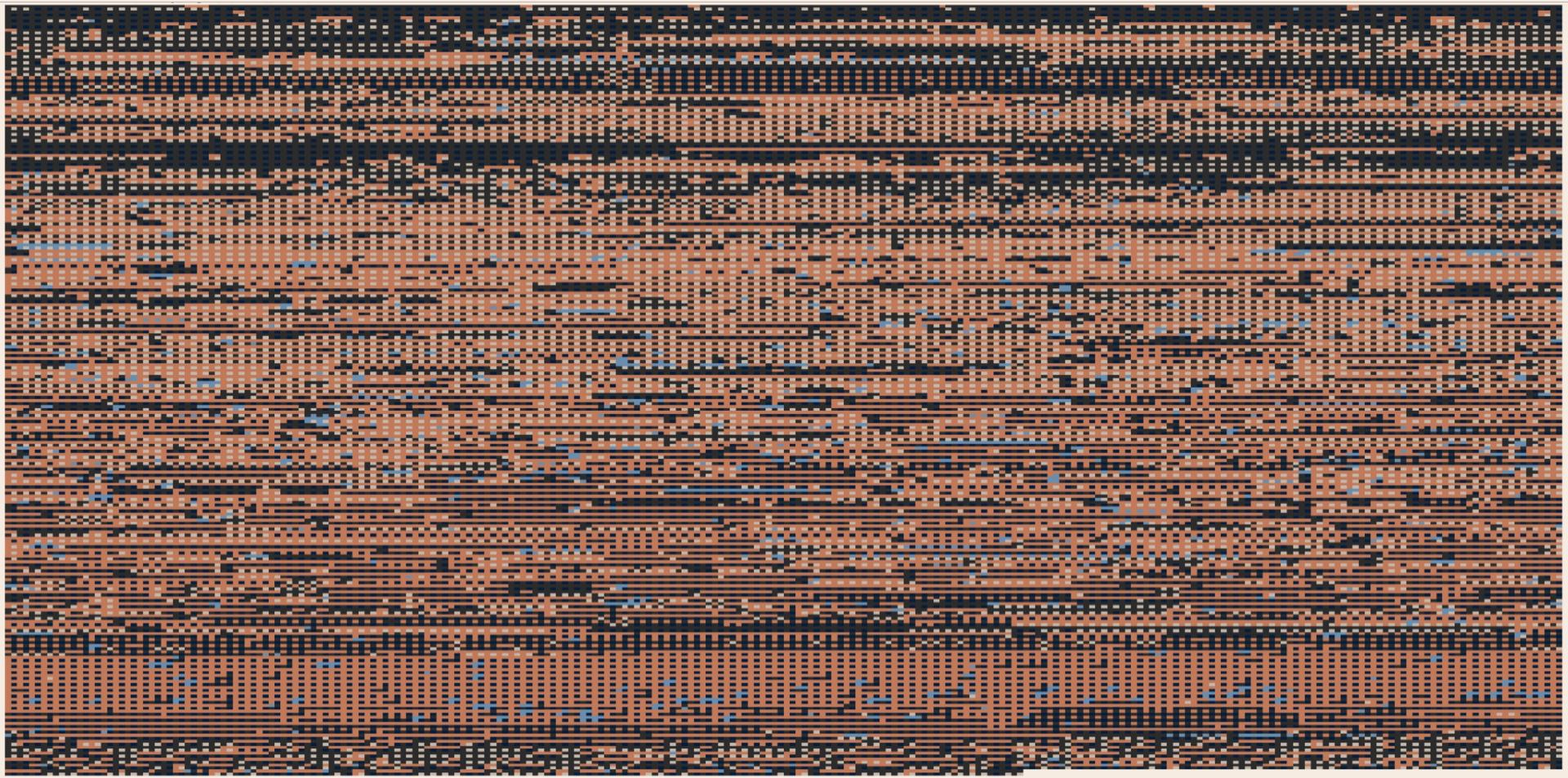
CONTRABAND

ART FROM NOBODY KNOWS WHERE

Bootleg digging unearths such antiquities as this.

NOT EXACTLY WHERE, ANYWAY. AND NOT EXACTLY HOW, EITHER. BUT DESPITE THE MYSTERY OF IT ALL, MILLIONS OF DOLLARS' WORTH OF MEXICAN ART TREASURES SOMEHOW FIND THEIR WAY TO THE UNITED STATES EACH YEAR.

William Jerome Gill, "Contraband: Art from Nobody Knows Where."
Saturday Evening Post. 8 February 1964. p. 58. Box 122, Folder 3, 2017.M.38, GRI.



Special thanks to:

Mary Miller
Andrew Turner
Michael Mathiowetz
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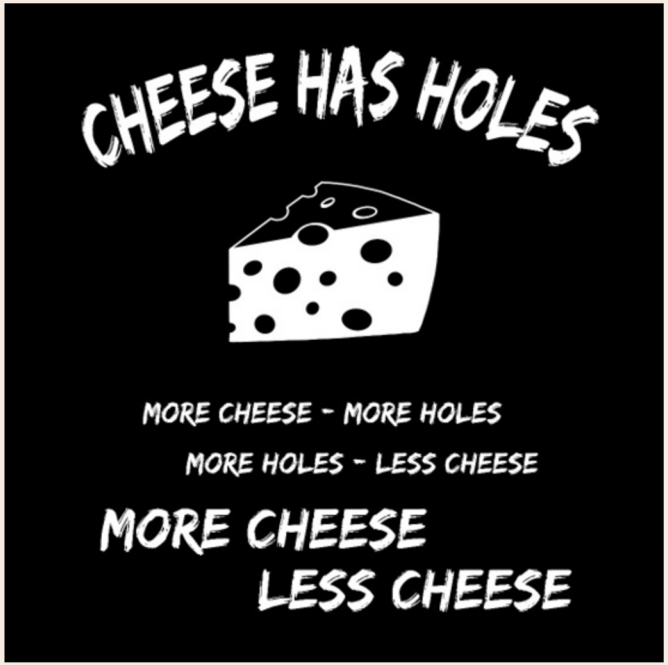
Kim Richter
Khristaan Villela
Megan O'Neil
Matthew Robb
Ellen Hoobler
Maria Galban
Nathan Sowry
Stephanie Crawford
Scott Bell



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